

Word family: **caution** / **cautions** / **cautioned** / **cautioning** / **cautious** / **cautiously** / **cautionary** / **cautionary tale**

Base word: **caution**

Part of speech: mainly **noun** and **verb**

Related forms:

caution (n.) — 謹慎；小心；警告；告誡

caution (v.) — 警告；告誡；提醒小心

cautious (adj.) — 謹慎的；小心的

cautiously (adv.) — 謹慎地；小心地

cautionary (adj.) — 警示性的；引以為戒的

cautionary tale (n.) — 警世故事；前車之鑑

precaution (related lexical extension) — 預防措施

precautionary (related lexical extension) — 預防性的

Major useful extensions:

exercise caution, use caution, proceed with caution, approach something with caution, treat something with caution, extreme caution, considerable caution, due caution, caution is advised, caution against, caution about, caution someone against doing something, caution someone to do something, caution that..., sound a note of caution, a word of caution, err on the side of caution, throw caution to the wind, cautionary tale, cautionary example, cautionary note, caution sign, caution tape, police caution, under caution, caution someone for an offence, formal caution, receive a caution, football caution, be cautioned, cautious approach, cautious optimism, cautious investor, cautious estimate, cautiously optimistic.

Meaning in this passage

> For instance, a product team may push for speed, while the compliance team insists on **caution**.

Here, **caution** means:

careful behaviour intended to avoid mistakes, danger, legal problems, or unnecessary risk — 謹慎；小心行事

The compliance team wants the project to proceed carefully rather than quickly, because moving too fast could create:

- * regulatory problems,
- * legal risk,
- * safety issues,
- * errors,

* insufficient checking.

****中文翻譯：****

例如，產品團隊可能會力求加快進度，而合規團隊則堅持要****謹慎行事****。

So here:

**caution = 在有風險或不確定性的情況下，小心行動、避免草率決定**

A. CAREFULNESS / AVOIDING RISK

1. **caution = carefulness to avoid danger or mistakes — 謹慎；小心**

This is the exact sense used in your passage.

Practice 1 — original sentence

> The compliance team ****insists on caution****.

合規團隊堅持要****謹慎行事****。

Practice 2

> Caution is necessary when making major financial decisions.

作出重大財務決定時必須保持****謹慎****。

Practice 3

> The situation requires both speed and caution.

這個情況既需要速度，也需要****謹慎****。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****caution = 為避免危險、錯誤或不必要風險而採取的小心態度****

2. **exercise caution — 保持謹慎；小心行事**

A major formal collocation.

Practice 1

> Employees should **exercise caution** when handling confidential information.

員工處理機密資料時應該**保持謹慎**。

Practice 2

> Investors are advised to exercise caution.

投資者被建議**謹慎行事**。

MCQ-ready definition:

exercise caution = 刻意以小心、避免風險的方式行動

3. **use caution — 小心；謹慎操作**

Practice 1

> **Use caution** when opening the container.

打開容器時要**小心**。

Practice 2

> Drivers should use caution in heavy rain.

駕駛者在大雨時應**小心駕駛**。

MCQ-ready definition:

use caution = 採取小心做法以避免危險

Especially common in instructions and warnings.

4. **proceed with caution — 謹慎進行**

A major expression.

Practice 1

> The team decided to **proceed with caution**.

團隊決定**謹慎推進**。

Practice 2

> We can continue, but we should proceed with caution.

我們可以繼續，但應該**小心進行**。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****proceed with caution = 繼續行動，但要特別注意風險和可能問題****

5. ****approach something with caution — 謹慎處理 / 看待某事****

Practice 1

> Managers should ****approach the change with caution****.

管理人員應該****謹慎處理這項改變****。

Practice 2

> New technology should be approached with caution when the risks are unclear.

如果風險尚未清楚，新科技應該****審慎採用****。

6. ****treat something with caution — 謹慎看待某事****

Especially with information, claims, estimates, research.

Practice 1

> These figures should be ****treated with caution****.

這些數字應該****審慎看待****。

Practice 2

> The early results must be interpreted with caution.

早期結果必須****謹慎解讀****。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****treat X with caution = 不完全立即相信或依賴 X，而是小心評估其限制和風險****

7. ****extreme caution — 極度謹慎****

Practice 1

> The chemicals must be handled with ****extreme caution****.

處理這些化學品時必須****極度小心****。

Practice 2

> Extreme caution is required in severe weather.

惡劣天氣下必須****格外謹慎****。

8. ****considerable / great caution — 相當 / 高度謹慎****

Practice 1

> The proposal should be considered with ****considerable caution****.

這項方案應該以****相當謹慎的態度****考慮。

Practice 2

> Doctors approached the unusual case with great caution.

醫生以****高度謹慎****態度處理這宗罕見個案。

9. ****due caution — 應有的謹慎****

Formal.

Practice 1

> The decision was made with ****due caution****.

這項決定是在保持****應有謹慎****的情況下作出的。

Practice 2

> Staff should exercise due caution before releasing information.

員工發布資料前應保持**應有的小心**。

MCQ-ready definition:

due caution = 在某情況下合理、適當而應有的謹慎程度

10. **caution is advised — 建議謹慎**

Practice 1

> **Caution is advised** when interpreting small samples.

解讀小型樣本時**宜保持謹慎**。

Practice 2

> Caution is advised during periods of severe market volatility.

市場極度波動時**建議謹慎行事**。

B. A CAUTIOUS APPROACH / ATTITUDE

11. **a cautious approach — 謹慎的做法**

Practice 1

> The compliance team favoured **a cautious approach**.

合規團隊傾向採取**謹慎做法**。

Practice 2

> A cautious approach can reduce avoidable errors.

審慎的方法可以減少可避免的錯誤。

12. **take a cautious approach — 採取謹慎方針**

Practice 1

> Management chose to **take a cautious approach** to expansion.

管理層選擇對擴張**採取審慎方針**。

Practice 2

> The company is taking a cautious approach to hiring.

公司正對招聘**採取謹慎策略**。

13. **cautious = careful about avoiding risk — 謹慎的；小心的**

Practice 1

> The compliance team was more **cautious**.

合規團隊較為**謹慎**。

Practice 2

> She is naturally cautious about major investments.

她對重大投資一向非常**謹慎**。

MCQ-ready definition:

cautious = 不輕率行動，會先考慮可能的風險和後果

14. **cautious about something — 對某事持謹慎態度**

Practice 1

> Investors are **cautious about the outlook**.

投資者對前景持**謹慎態度**。

Practice 2

> The company is cautious about expanding too quickly.

公司對過快擴張保持**謹慎**。

15. **cautious in doing something — 做某事時謹慎**

Practice 1

> She was **cautious in making promises**.

她作出承諾時非常**謹慎**。

Practice 2

> Managers should be cautious in interpreting incomplete data.

管理人員解讀不完整數據時應該**小心**。

16. **cautious decision / response — 謹慎的決定 / 回應**

Practice 1

> The board gave a **cautious response**.

董事會作出**謹慎回應**。

Practice 2

> Delaying the launch was a cautious decision.

延遲推出是一個**審慎決定**。

17. **cautious investor — 謹慎型投資者**

Practice 1

> A **cautious investor** may prefer lower-risk assets.

謹慎型投資者可能較喜歡低風險資產。

Practice 2

> Cautious investors usually focus heavily on downside risk.

****審慎投資者**通常十分關注下行風險。**

18. ****cautious estimate — 保守 / 謹慎估計****

Practice 1

> A ****cautious estimate**** puts the cost at around \$2 million.

按****較保守的估計****，成本約為二百萬元。

Practice 2

> Even a cautious estimate suggests demand will increase.

即使按****謹慎估計****，需求仍會上升。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****cautious estimate = 刻意避免過分樂觀或誇大的估計****

C. CAUTIOUS OPTIMISM

19. ****cautious optimism — 審慎樂觀****

A major fixed collocation.

Practice 1

> The results have created ****cautious optimism****.

結果令人產生****審慎樂觀****情緒。

Practice 2

> There is cautious optimism that the project will succeed.

人們對項目成功抱有****審慎樂觀態度****。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****cautious optimism = 有理由感到樂觀，但仍意識到存在風險和不確定性****

20. **cautiously optimistic — 審慎樂觀的**

Practice 1

> Managers are **cautiously optimistic** about the launch.

管理層對產品推出抱**審慎樂觀**態度。

Practice 2

> She remains cautiously optimistic.

她仍然**審慎樂觀**。

21. **cautiously = in a careful way — 謹慎地；小心地**

Practice 1

> The team moved **cautiously**.

團隊**謹慎地**推進。

Practice 2

> He answered the question cautiously.

他**謹慎地**回答了問題。

D. WARNING SOMEONE

22. **caution someone — 警告 / 告誡某人**

A second major branch of **caution**.

Practice 1

> The manager **cautioned the team** about rushing.

經理**告誡團隊**不要過於急進。

Practice 2

> Doctors cautioned patients about possible side effects.

醫生**提醒病人注意**可能的副作用。

MCQ-ready definition:

caution someone = 告訴某人存在風險，提醒他們小心

23. **caution someone about something — 提醒某人注意某事**

Practice 1

> She **cautioned us about the risks**.

她**提醒我們注意風險**。

Practice 2

> The report cautions readers about the limitations of the data.

報告**提醒讀者留意**數據的限制。

24. **caution someone against something — 告誡某人不要做某事**

Practice 1

> Experts **cautioned against excessive optimism**.

專家**告誡人們不要過分樂觀**。

Practice 2

> The adviser cautioned us against making a rushed decision.

顧問**提醒我們不要倉促作決定**。

MCQ-ready definition:

caution against X = 警告別人 X 可能帶來不良後果，因此應避免或小心

25. **caution someone against doing something — 告誡某人不要.....**

Practice 1

> The compliance officer **cautioned staff against ignoring the rules**.

合規主任**告誡員工不要忽視規則**。

Practice 2

> She cautioned him against investing too much.

她**警告他不要投資過多**。

26. **caution someone to do something — 提醒某人要.....**

Practice 1

> Employees were **cautioned to check the figures carefully**.

員工被**提醒要仔細核對數字**。

Practice 2

> Visitors were cautioned to stay on the path.

訪客被**警告要留在指定路徑上**。

MCQ-ready definition:

caution someone to do X = 因存在風險而提醒某人採取某項小心措施

27. **caution that... — 警告 / 提醒說.....**

Practice 1

> Analysts **cautioned that the figures were preliminary**.

分析員**提醒這些數字仍屬初步資料**。

Practice 2

> The report cautions that rapid expansion may increase risk.

報告**警告快速擴張可能增加風險**。

28. **caution someone not to do something — 警告某人不要.....**

Practice 1

> The lawyer **cautioned him not to make public statements**.

律師**告誡他不要公開發言**。

Practice 2

> Staff were cautioned not to share confidential information.

員工被**警告不要分享機密資料**。

E. NOUN: WARNING / ADVICE TO BE CAREFUL

29. **a caution = warning — 警告；告誡**

Practice 1

> The report includes **a caution about interpreting the results**.

報告包含一項有關解讀結果的**提醒 / 警告**。

Practice 2

> His comments were intended as a caution.

他的評論是為了作出**警示**。

MCQ-ready definition:

a caution = 提醒某人注意危險、錯誤或不良後果的警告

30. **a word of caution — 一句提醒；警告一句**

A very common expression.

Practice 1

> **A word of caution:** the figures are only estimates.

提醒一句：這些數字只是估計。

Practice 2

> Before we continue, I'd like to offer a word of caution.

在我們繼續之前，我想先作一點**提醒**。

MCQ-ready definition:

a word of caution = 在別人行動前給予的一項簡短風險提醒

31. **sound a note of caution — 提醒要保持謹慎**

Formal, common in analytical writing.

Practice 1

> Several experts **sounded a note of caution**.

數名專家**提醒大家應保持謹慎**。

Practice 2

> The report sounds a note of caution about future growth.

報告對未來增長**提出審慎警告**。

MCQ-ready definition:

sound a note of caution = 在普遍樂觀或積極氣氛中提醒人們仍然存在風險

32. **note of caution — 警示；審慎提醒**

Practice 1

> The positive report ended with **a note of caution**.

這份正面報告最後加入了一項**審慎提醒**。

Practice 2

> There was one note of caution in the otherwise optimistic presentation.

整體樂觀的簡報中有一點**警示意味**。

33. **cautionary note — 警示性提醒**

Practice 1

> The report ends on a **cautionary note**.

報告以一個**警示性的提醒**作結。

Practice 2

> Her experience provides a cautionary note for other managers.

她的經驗為其他管理人員提供一個**值得警惕的提醒**。

F. CAUTIONARY = SERVING AS A WARNING

34. **cautionary = intended to warn — 警示性的；引以為戒的**

Practice 1

> The case provides a **cautionary example**.

這宗個案提供了一個**警示性的例子**。

Practice 2

> It is a cautionary reminder of what can go wrong.

這是一個提醒我們可能出現甚麼問題的**警示**。

MCQ-ready definition:

cautionary = 用來警告人們某種行為可能導致壞結果的

35. **cautionary tale — 警世故事；前車之鑑**

A major fixed expression.

Practice 1

> The failed project became a **cautionary tale** for other companies.

這個失敗項目成為其他公司的**前車之鑑**。

Practice 2

> His experience is a cautionary tale about poor planning.

他的經驗是一個有關規劃不善的**警世故事**。

MCQ-ready definition:

cautionary tale = 描述壞結果、用來警告別人不要犯同樣錯誤的故事或真實案例

36. **cautionary example — 警示例子**

Practice 1

> The collapse offers a **cautionary example** of excessive borrowing.

這次崩潰提供了一個過度借貸的**警示例子**。

Practice 2

> The incident became a cautionary example for new staff.

這宗事件成為新員工的**前車之鑑**。

G. SIGNS / PHYSICAL WARNINGS

37. **Caution! = warning sign/message — 小心！注意！**

Practice 1

> The sign said, **Caution: Wet Floor.**

標誌寫着：「**小心：地面濕滑**。」

Practice 2

> “Caution” was printed on the machine.

機器上印有「**注意 / 小心**」。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****Caution! = 用來警告附近可能有危險的正式提示語****

38. ****caution sign — 警告標誌****

Practice 1

> A ****caution sign**** was placed beside the wet floor.

濕地旁放置了****警告標誌****。

Practice 2

> Drivers should obey caution signs.

駕駛者應遵守****警示標誌****。

39. ****caution tape — 警示帶；警戒帶****

Practice 1

> The area was surrounded by ****caution tape****.

該區被****警示帶****圍起來。

Practice 2

> Workers placed caution tape around the damaged structure.

工人在受損結構周圍拉起****警戒帶****。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****caution tape = 用來封鎖或標示潛在危險區域的鮮明膠帶****

H. POLICE / LEGAL CAUTION

40. **police caution = formal warning in criminal-law contexts — 警方警誡 / 正式警告**

Especially important in BrE and some Commonwealth legal contexts.

Practice 1

> The suspect was given a **police caution**.

疑犯受到警方的**正式警誡**。

Practice 2

> The precise meaning of a caution depends on the legal system.

caution 的法律含義取決於相關司法制度。

MCQ-ready definition:

police caution = 警方在刑事程序中給出的正式警告或法律性警誡；具體制度因司法管轄區而異

41. **caution someone for an offence — 就罪行正式警告某人**

Practice 1

> He was **cautioned for a minor offence**.

他因一項輕微違法行為受到警方**正式警誡**。

Practice 2

> The exact legal effect of being cautioned varies by jurisdiction.

被**正式警誡**的法律後果會因司法制度而異。

42. **receive a caution — 收到正式警誡**

Practice 1

> She received a formal **caution**.

她收到一項正式**警誡**。

Practice 2

> A caution is not necessarily the same as a criminal conviction.

****警誡**不一定等同於刑事定罪。**

43. ****under caution — 在正式警誡下接受問話****

Especially BrE police/legal usage.

Practice 1

> He was interviewed ****under caution****.

他在警方正式****警誡****下接受問話。

Practice 2

> Statements made under caution may have legal significance.

在****警誡下****作出的陳述可能具有法律意義。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****under caution = 在警方已正式告知相關權利和法律後果後接受問話****

44. ****caution someone before questioning — 問話前作正式警誡****

Practice 1

> Officers ****cautioned the suspect before questioning him****.

警員在問話前先向疑犯作出****正式警誡****。

Practice 2

> Legal wording varies between jurisdictions.

正式警誡的法律措辭因司法管轄區而異。

I. SPORTS: FORMAL WARNING

45. **caution = official warning to a player — 警告；黃牌警告**

Especially association football.

Practice 1

> The referee gave the defender a **caution**.

裁判向後衛作出**警告**。

Practice 2

> A caution is normally shown with a yellow card in football.

足球比賽中的正式**警告**通常以黃牌表示。

MCQ-ready definition:

caution = 裁判因球員犯規或不當行為而作出的正式警告

46. **caution a player — 警告球員；出示黃牌**

Practice 1

> The referee **cautioned the player for dissent**.

裁判因球員抗議判決而向他**出示黃牌警告**。

Practice 2

> Two players were cautioned in the first half.

上半場有兩名球員**被黃牌警告**。

47. **book vs caution in football — 記名警告 / 黃牌**

Practice 1

> The player was **booked / cautioned** for the foul.

球員因犯規被**記名警告 / 出示黃牌**。

Practice 2

> “Book” is common everyday football language; “caution” is more formal.

****book**** 在足球日常語言中很常見，而 ****caution**** 較正式。

J. FIXED EXPRESSIONS ABOUT CAUTION

48. ****err on the side of caution — 寧可謹慎一點；寧可保守****

A very important idiom.

Practice 1

> If you're unsure, ****err on the side of caution****.

如果你不肯定，****寧可謹慎一點****。

Practice 2

> Compliance teams often prefer to err on the side of caution.

合規團隊往往傾向****寧可保守一點，也不要冒險****。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****err on the side of caution = 在不確定時選擇風險較低、較保守的做法，即使可能過度小心****

This fits your passage extremely well.

49. ****throw caution to the wind(s) — 不顧一切；把謹慎拋諸腦後****

Almost the opposite.

Practice 1

> He ****threw caution to the wind**** and invested everything.

他****不顧風險****，把所有資金都投了進去。

Practice 2

> The team cannot simply throw caution to the winds in order to move faster.

團隊不能為了加快速度而完全**不顧風險**。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****throw caution to the wind(s) = 刻意停止謹慎考慮，冒險行動****

Both singular ****wind**** and plural ****winds**** occur.

50. ****abandon caution — 放棄謹慎****

Practice 1

> The company should not ****abandon caution**** merely to meet the deadline.

公司不應只為趕上截止日期便****放棄謹慎原則****。

Practice 2

> Rising confidence led some investors to abandon caution.

信心上升令部分投資者****不再謹慎****。

51. ****temper something with caution — 以謹慎平衡某事****

Formal.

Practice 1

> Optimism should be ****tempered with caution****.

樂觀應該同時配合****謹慎態度****。

Practice 2

> Ambition needs to be tempered by caution.

雄心也需要以****謹慎****加以平衡。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****temper X with caution = 降低 X 過度發展的程度，加入謹慎考慮作平衡****

K. PRECAUTION FAMILY EXTENSION

This is closely related and pedagogically very useful, but it is not interchangeable with **caution**.

52. **precaution** = action taken beforehand to prevent harm — 預防措施

Practice 1

> Wearing protective equipment is a sensible **precaution**.

穿戴保護裝備是一項合理的**預防措施**。

Practice 2

> The company took additional precautions before the launch.

公司在推出前採取額外**防範措施**。

MCQ-ready definition:

precaution = 在問題或危險發生之前採取的具體防範行動

53. **take precautions** — 採取預防措施

Practice 1

> Staff should **take precautions** when handling sensitive data.

員工處理敏感數據時應**採取防範措施**。

Practice 2

> The organisers took extra precautions.

主辦方採取了額外**安全措施**。

54. **safety precaution** — 安全預防措施

Practice 1

> Wearing a helmet is an important **safety precaution**.

戴頭盔是一項重要的**安全措施**。

Practice 2

> Check all safety precautions before operating the machine.

操作機器前檢查所有**安全防範措施**。

55. **as a precaution — 作為預防措施；以防萬一**

Practice 1

> The building was evacuated **as a precaution**.

大樓被疏散，**以防萬一**。

Practice 2

> She backed up the files as a precaution.

她**為安全起見**備份了檔案。

56. **precautionary = done to prevent possible harm — 預防性的**

Practice 1

> The company took **precautionary measures**.

公司採取了**預防措施**。

Practice 2

> The closure was precautionary.

關閉措施屬於**預防性質**。

57. **precautionary measure — 預防措施**

Practice 1

> Additional checks were introduced as a **precautionary measure**.

公司新增檢查作為一項**預防措施**。

Practice 2

> The temporary suspension was purely precautionary.

暫停措施純粹出於**預防考慮**。

Important distinction 1: **caution vs carefulness**

carefulness

general quality of being careful.

caution

especially carefulness because:

- * danger,
- * uncertainty,
- * risk,
- * possible negative consequences exist.

> He completed the work with great carefulness.

> 他很仔細地完成工作。

> The situation requires caution.

> 情況存在風險，所以需要**謹慎**。

Important distinction 2: **caution vs care**

care

very broad:

- * careful attention,
- * concern,
- * responsibility.

caution

specifically emphasizes avoiding risk or harm.

> handle with care

> 小心處理

> proceed with caution

> 謹慎行事

Important distinction 3: **caution vs cautious**

caution

noun:

> We need caution.

> 我們需要保持**謹慎**。

cautious

adjective:

> We need to be cautious.

> 我們需要**謹慎**。

Important distinction 4: **caution vs cautiously**

Noun:

> act with caution

Adverb:

> act cautiously

Both mean roughly:

> 謹慎行動

but grammar differs.

Important distinction 5: **caution vs warning**

warning

information that danger/problem exists.

caution

can mean:

1. the careful attitude itself, or
2. a warning encouraging that attitude.

Compare:

- > Exercise caution.
- > 保持謹慎。

- > He gave us a warning.
- > 他向我們發出警告。

Important distinction 6: **caution vs alert**

alert

specifically make someone aware of danger/problem.

caution

warn them and often advise them to behave carefully.

- > alert staff to a security problem
- > 提醒員工有保安問題

- > caution staff against sharing passwords
- > 警告員工不要分享密碼

Important distinction 7: **caution vs advise**

advise

give a recommendation.

caution

give advice with a strong risk-warning element.

> advise someone to wait

> 建議某人等候

> caution someone against acting too quickly

> 告誡某人不要過快行動

Important distinction 8: **caution vs warn**

They overlap heavily.

warn

strongly tell someone that danger or trouble may happen.

caution

often sounds slightly more formal and may emphasize measured care rather than severe danger.

> warn of a fire risk

> 警告火災風險

> caution against rushing

> 告誡不要急進

Important distinction 9: **caution vs concern**

concern

worry or an issue causing worry.

caution

careful behaviour prompted by risk.

> concerns about safety

> 對安全的擔憂

- > exercise caution for safety reasons
- > 因安全理由保持謹慎

Important distinction 10: **caution vs restraint**

restraint

holding yourself back from acting strongly/excessively.

caution

careful action because of risk.

- > show restraint during an argument
- > 爭論時保持克制

- > show caution before approving a risky plan
- > 批准高風險方案前保持謹慎

Important distinction 11: **caution vs hesitation**

hesitation

delay because of uncertainty.

caution

careful evaluation of risk.

A cautious person does not necessarily hesitate.

They can act decisively after careful assessment.

Important distinction 12: **caution vs reluctance**

reluctance

unwillingness to do something.

caution

willingness may exist, but action is careful.

> reluctant to invest

> 不太願意投資

> cautious about investing

> 願意考慮投資，但非常謹慎

Important distinction 13: **cautious vs conservative**

cautious

tries to avoid unnecessary risk.

conservative

in non-political contexts can mean deliberately moderate, restrained or low-estimate.

> cautious decision

> 謹慎決定

> conservative estimate

> 保守估計

They overlap but are not identical.

Important distinction 14: **cautious vs risk-averse**

cautious

generally careful.

risk-averse

specifically strongly prefers less risk.

A cautious decision-maker may still accept significant risk after analysis.

Important distinction 15: ****cautious vs timid****

****cautious****

usually neutral or positive: sensible care.

****timid****

lacking confidence/courage.

> cautious manager

> 謹慎的經理

> timid manager

> 膽怯、不敢決定的經理

Do not confuse sensible caution with fearfulness.

Important distinction 16: ****cautious vs hesitant****

****cautious****

carefully evaluates.

****hesitant****

has difficulty deciding or acting.

You can be cautious but decisive.

Important distinction 17: ****cautious optimism vs optimism****

****optimism****

belief that things will go well.

****cautious optimism****

hopeful, but still recognizes significant uncertainty and risk.

This is very common in:

- * business,
- * medicine,
- * economics,
- * research.

Important distinction 18: ****caution someone about vs caution someone against****

****caution someone about X****

warn them about the risks associated with X.

- > caution investors about volatility
- > 提醒投資者注意波動

****caution someone against X****

advise them not to do/choose X.

- > caution investors against borrowing excessively
- > 告誡投資者不要過度借貸

Important distinction 19: ****caution against + noun/-ing****

Natural:

- > caution against ****rapid expansion****
- > caution against ****moving too quickly****

Because ****against**** is a preposition.

Important distinction 20: ****caution someone to do vs caution someone against doing****

Compare:

- > caution staff ****to check everything carefully****
- > 提醒員工要仔細檢查

- > caution staff ****against skipping checks****
- > 告誡員工不要省略檢查

Positive instruction vs warning against action.

Important distinction 21: **a word of caution vs warning**

a word of caution

often relatively measured and polite.

a warning

can sound stronger and more urgent.

> A word of caution: these results are preliminary.

> 提醒一下：結果仍屬初步。

> Warning: high voltage.

> 警告：高壓電。

Important distinction 22: **sound a note of caution**

This often appears when other people are:

* optimistic,

* enthusiastic,

* moving quickly.

The speaker introduces a balancing concern.

So it is especially useful in analytical writing.

Important distinction 23: **cautionary vs cautious**

cautious

the person/action itself is careful.

> cautious manager

> 謹慎的經理

cautionary

something serves as a warning.

> cautionary tale

> 警世故事

Do not interchange them.

Important distinction 24: **cautionary vs precautionary**

Very important.

cautionary

warns people by showing what may go wrong.

> cautionary tale

> 警世故事

precautionary

done beforehand to prevent something bad.

> precautionary measure

> 預防措施

So:

> cautionary = **警示作用**

> precautionary = **預防作用**

Important distinction 25: **caution vs precaution**

caution

attitude of being careful.

precaution

concrete action taken beforehand.

Example:

> We proceeded with caution.

> 我們**謹慎行事**。

> We made a backup as a precaution.

> 我們備份檔案作為**預防措施**。

This is one of the most useful family distinctions.

Important distinction 26: **precaution vs prevention**

precaution

one specific preventive step.

prevention

the broader act/process of stopping something from happening.

> wear gloves as a precaution

> 戴手套作為預防措施

> disease prevention

> 疾病預防

Important distinction 27: **err on the side of caution**

This does **not** mean:

> make a careless error.

Here **err** means:

if you are going to make a judgment error, make it in the safer direction.

So:

> better slightly too cautious than not cautious enough.

Important distinction 28: **throw caution to the wind**

This is nearly the opposite of:

> err on the side of caution.

Compare:

err on the side of caution

寧可太小心

throw caution to the wind

索性不管風險

Excellent idiomatic contrast.

Important distinction 29: **police caution vs ordinary caution**

Ordinary:

> Use caution.

> 小心。

Legal:

> He received a police caution.

> 他受到警方正式警誡。

Same noun, very different institutional meaning.

Important distinction 30: **legal caution varies by jurisdiction**

Do not assume every country uses **caution** in exactly the same legal way.

Depending on the system, it can refer to:

- * formal warning,
- * statement of rights,
- * criminal justice disposal,
- * questioning procedure.

So the surrounding legal jurisdiction matters.

Important distinction 31: **sports caution**

In football:

> a caution

is an **official disciplinary warning**, usually represented by a yellow card.

This is not simply advice to play carefully.

Important distinction 32: **caution sign vs caution itself**

caution

the concept of carefulness/warning.

caution sign

physical sign communicating the warning.

Important distinction 33: **compliance + caution in your passage**

This pairing is very natural because compliance work often emphasizes:

- * rules,
- * legal requirements,
- * documentation,
- * risk,
- * approval procedures,
- * avoiding violations.

So:

> product team → **speed**

> compliance team → **caution**

is deliberately constructed as a tension between:

move quickly

and

avoid preventable risk

Important distinction 34: **caution does not necessarily mean “stop”**

This is crucial.

If someone says:

> proceed with caution

they do **not** necessarily mean:

> don't proceed.

They mean:

continue, but do so carefully

So in your passage the compliance team may not oppose the project itself; it may oppose
rushing it.

Important distinction 35: **caution does not automatically mean fear**

Caution can come from:

- * expertise,
- * good judgment,
- * uncertainty,
- * responsible risk management.

It need not imply cowardice or panic.

Important distinction 36: **caution in your passage**

The phrase is:

> ****insists on caution****

This means more than:

> “would prefer everyone to be careful.”

****insist on****

shows that the compliance team regards caution as:

****a requirement that should not be sacrificed merely for speed****

That creates the paragraph's conflict:

> ****product team:**** faster launch

> ****compliance team:**** adequate checking and risk control

Without communication, both sides may view the other's priority as unreasonable.

Family-extension note

The ****caution**** family has several major modern branches:

1. ****carefulness / risk avoidance****

* exercise caution

* proceed with caution

2. ****cautious attitude****

* cautious approach

* cautious investor

3. ****measured optimism****

* cautious optimism

* cautiously optimistic

4. ****verb: warn****

* caution someone

* caution against

5. ****warning noun****

- * a caution
- * word of caution
- * note of caution

6. **warning example**

- * cautionary
- * cautionary tale

7. **physical warnings**

- * caution sign
- * caution tape

8. **law/police**

- * police caution
- * under caution

9. **sport**

- * caution a player
- * receive a caution

10. **fixed idioms**

- * err on the side of caution
- * throw caution to the wind

11. **preventive related family**

- * precaution
- * precautionary measure

For your passage, the exact branch is:

caution = careful risk-aware behaviour intended to prevent mistakes, regulatory problems, or other negative consequences

Master comparison

Form / expression	Traditional Chinese	Core idea
-----	-----	-----

caution (carefulness)	謹慎；小心	avoid risk	
exercise caution	保持謹慎	deliberate carefulness	
use caution	小心行事	risk avoidance	
proceed with caution	謹慎進行	continue carefully	
approach with caution	謹慎處理	careful approach	
treat with caution	審慎看待	don't rely too quickly	
extreme caution	極度謹慎	high level of care	
due caution	應有的謹慎	appropriate care	
caution is advised	建議謹慎	recommendation	
cautious	謹慎的	risk-aware adjective	
cautious approach	謹慎方針	approach	
cautious investor	謹慎型投資者	risk attitude	
cautious estimate	保守 / 謹慎估計	restrained estimate	
cautious optimism	審慎樂觀	optimism + risk awareness	
cautiously optimistic	審慎樂觀的	balanced optimism	
cautiously	謹慎地	adverb	
caution someone	警告 / 告誡某人	warn	
caution about X	提醒注意 X	warning	
caution against X	告誡不要 X	discourage risky action	
caution someone to do X	提醒某人要 X	careful instruction	
caution that...	警告 / 提醒說.....	warning statement	
a caution	警告；提醒	warning noun	
a word of caution	一句提醒	brief warning	
note of caution	審慎警示	balancing warning	
sound a note of caution	提醒保持謹慎	warn amid optimism	
cautionary	警示性的	serves as warning	
cautionary tale	警世故事；前車之鑑	warning example	
cautionary example	警示例子	lesson from failure	
Caution!	小心！注意！	warning notice	
caution sign	警告標誌	safety sign	
caution tape	警示帶 / 警戒帶	physical warning	
police caution	警方正式警誡	law	
under caution	在正式警誡下	police questioning	
caution someone for an offence	就罪行警誡某人	legal warning	
caution (football)	黃牌警告	sports discipline	
caution a player	向球員警告 / 出黃牌	referee action	
err on the side of caution	寧可謹慎一點	safer choice	
throw caution to the wind	不顧風險	abandon caution	
temper X with caution	以謹慎平衡 X	moderation	
precaution	預防措施	preventive action	
take precautions	採取預防措施	prevention	
as a precaution	以防萬一	preventive purpose	
precautionary	預防性的	preventive	
precautionary measure	預防措施	preventive action	

For your original sentence

> For instance, a product team may push for speed, while the compliance team **insists on caution**; without proper communication, these differing aims can delay the entire project.

Here:

caution = 合規團隊認為在推出產品或繼續項目前，必須仔細檢查規則、風險和可能後果，不能單純為了加快進度而草率行事

A natural Traditional Chinese rendering is:

> 例如，產品團隊可能會力求加快進度，而合規團隊則**堅持必須謹慎行事**；如果缺乏適當溝通，這些不同目標可能會拖延整個項目。

The cleanest contrast is:

- > **care** = 小心 / 仔細，最廣泛
- > **caution** = 因存在風險而保持謹慎
- > **warning** = 告訴別人有危險
- > **precaution** = 為防止危險而預先採取的具體措施
- > **cautious** = 謹慎的
- > **cautionary** = 具有警示作用的
- > **precautionary** = 具有預防作用的

And the passage's contrast is particularly precise:

- > **push for speed** = 積極要求更快
- > **insist on caution** = 堅持不能犧牲必要的謹慎與風險控制

So **caution** here is best understood not as fear or reluctance, but as **deliberate risk control**.